

List of Kanji

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漢字 1: Cargo (荷)

荷 (10 strokes)

Cargo, burden.

As mentioned in Entry ??, this is the only general-use 漢字 in which the character for ‘what’ appears as a component.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 艹 + 何

English Grass + What (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The cargo of [herbs] is used for [what] purpose?

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. カ (KA)

に (ni)

The kun-yomi is by far the more common reading.

L.C. —

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The cargo <niggled> us that we started (CUSSING).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Note that the second compound uses the less common 音読み of 物 (“thing”, from Entry ??).		
重荷	heavy + cargo = <i>heavy burden / load</i>	おもに (omoni)
荷物	cargo + thing = <i>luggage; baggage</i>	にモツ (niMOTSU)
出荷	exit + cargo = <i>shipment; shipping</i>	シュツカ (SHUK-KA)

漢字 2: Port (港)

港 (12 strokes)

Port, harbor.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 氵 + 共 + 己

English Water + Together (??) + Oneself

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The port [together] with the [water] amazes [oneself].

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. コウ (KŌ)

みなと (minato)

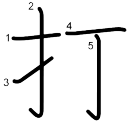
L.C. —

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

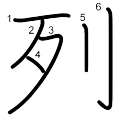
The port <CAUSED> <Minato> to flee.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
港	<i>port; harbor</i>	みなと (minato)
入港	enter + port = <i>entering port; arrival</i>	ニュー・コウ (NYŪ-KŌ)
空港	empty (sky) + port = <i>airport</i>	クウ・コウ (KŪ-KŌ)

漢字 3: Hit (打)		
		
Hit, strike.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	扌 + 丁	
English	Hand + Block (??)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
The hitting [hand] must be able to [block].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ダ (DA)	う (u)
う is the more common reading. This is another 漢字 that will often incorporate its accompanying ひらがな when forming nouns.		
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Hit the <DUD> with a lot of <oomph>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
打つ	hit; strike	うつ (utsu)
打ち切る	hit + cut = stop doing something; break off	うち きる (uchi kiru)
打者	hit + individual = batter; hitter (in baseball)	ダ・シャ (DASHA)

漢字 4: Row (列)		
列		
Row (as in a row of objects).		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	歹 + 刂	
English	Death + Knife	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Rows	of [death and decay] left behind by the [sword].	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	レツ (RETSU)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The row <RETSU> obliterated.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
列島	row + island = island chain; archipelago	レツ・トウ (RET·TŌ)
列車	row + car = train	レツ・シャ (RESSHA)
系列	system + row = series; corporate group	ケイ・レツ (KEIRETSU)

漢字 5: Round (丸)		
丸	丸	
Round.		
By extension are the ideas of completion and wholeness, etc.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	九 + 丶
English	Nine (??) + Dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Round [9] of eating [Jelly Beans].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	まる (maru)
L.C.	ガン (GAN)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Round them up with <GUNS> and take their <amarula>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
丸い	<i>round</i>	まるい (marui)
丸める	<i>to make round</i>	まるめる (marumeru)
日の丸	sun + round = <i>The Japanese (rising sun) flag</i>	ひのまる (hinomaru)

漢字 6: Manor (館)		
館	館	
Manor, although this 漢字 can appear in compounds referring to anything from stately embassies to simple country inns.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	食 + 官
English	Eat/Food + Official (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Manor where all the [officials] [eat].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カン (KAN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
The manor was <CUNNINGLY> built.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry ?? that the first two 漢字 of the final compound mean ‘art’ when taken together.		
旅館	travel + manor = <i>Japanese-style inn</i>	リョ・カン (RYO-KAN)
図書館	diagram + write + manor = <i>library</i>	ト・ショ・カン (TOSHOKAN)
美術館	art + manor = <i>art museum</i>	ビ・ジュツ・カン (BIJUTSUKAN)

漢字 7: Fly (飛)

		
Fly.		
Take care with the stroke order of this 漢字.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	飛
English	Fly

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#183).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヒ (HI)	と (to)
The 訓読み can absorb its accompanying hiragan when forming nouns.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Take flight	to <HEAL> your <torrent> of sorrows.
-------------	--------------------------------------

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
When taken together, the first two 漢字 in the final compound mean ‘flight’, or ‘flying’.		
飛ぶ	<i>fly</i>	とぶ (to-bu)
飛び出す	fly + exit = <i>fly out</i> ; <i>jump out</i>	とび だす (tobi dasu)
飛行機	flight + mechanism = <i>aeroplane</i>	ヒコウキ (HI-KŌKI)

漢字 8: Number (数)

		
Number.		
When in the first position, this 漢字 will sometimes carry the meaning of ‘several’ of whatever is indicated by the character following it (e.g. years, persons, days, etc.).		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	米 + 女 + 攴
English	Rice + Woman + Whip

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Number of times [women] were [whipped] to work in the [rice] fields.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	スウ (SŪ)	かず、かぞ (kazu, kazo)
スウ is the most common reading, and the one used to express the idea of ‘several’ mentioned above. On rare occasions, the 音読み can become voiced; the final compound is an example.		
かず is the general word for ‘number’ and forms only a few compounds.		
かぞ is a verb stem (for the verb in the second example below).		
L.C.	ス (SU)	—

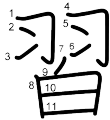
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The number of people following <SUIT> by selling <kazoos> in the <car zone> led them to being <SUED>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
数	<i>number</i>	かず (kazu)
数える	<i>count</i>	かぞえる (kazoeru)
数学	number + study = <i>mathematics</i>	スウ・ガク (SŪ-GAKU)
人数	person + number = <i>number of persons</i>	ニン・ズウ (NIN-ZŪ)

漢字 9: Learn (習)

		
Learn.		
Take care not to confuse this 漢字 with 皆 (??).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	羽 + 白
English	Feather + White

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Learn the [white] hues of [feathers].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シュウ (SHŪ)	なら (nara)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Learning the <Nara>-brand <SHOES>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
習う	learn; take lessons	ならう (narau)
自習	self + learn = learning by oneself	ジシュウ (JISHŪ)
習字	learn + character = penmanship	シュウジ (SHŪ-JI)

漢字 10: Display (展)

		
Display, spread.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	尸 + 衣 + 艹
English	Corpse/Body + Clothing + Plant/Grass

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
A display of a [corpse] and its [clothing] lying on the [grass].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	テン (TEN)	—
L.C.	—	—

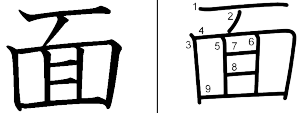
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The display was <TENSE>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
展開	display + open = unfolding; development	テンカイ (TEN-KAI)
展示	display + show = display; exhibition	テンジ (TEN-JI)
発展	discharge + display = development; expansion	ハツテン (HAT-TEN)

漢字 11: Mask (面)



Mask, aspect, face.

Underlying the meaning of this character is a sense of the surface appearance of things.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	面
English	Mask

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#176).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	メン (MEN)	おもて、おも (omote, omo)
L.C.	—	つら (tsura)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The masks, washed with <omo>, by <MEN> during the <stew lunch> <commotion>.

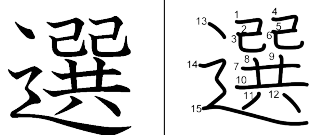
** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
真面目	true + mask + eye = <i>honest; earnest</i>	ま・じ・め (ma-jime)

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
面	<i>surface; face</i>	おもて (omote)
面白い	mask + white = <i>interesting</i>	おも しろい (omo shiroi)
面接	mask + join = <i>interview</i>	メン・セツ (MENSETSU)

漢字 12: Select (選)



Select, choose.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	己 + 共 + 辶
English	Oneself + Together (??) + Walk/Road

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Select by [oneself] who you are [walking] [together] with.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セン (SEN)	えら (era)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Choose, in the <CENTRE>, the <era> you want to time travel to.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
選ぶ	<i>select; choose</i>	えらぶ (era-bu)
選手	select + hand = <i>athlete</i>	セン・シュ (SEN-SHU)
特選	special + select = <i>special selection</i>	トク・セン (TOKU-SEN)

漢字 13: Homeward (帰)

帰	1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10	
Homeward, in the sense of going back or returning.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	リ + 彡 + 巾
English	Knife + Pig head/snout + Cloth

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Returning homeward, I [cut] off a [pig's head] and [covered] it in a piece of [cloth].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キ (KI)	かえ (kae)
The 訓読み becomes voiced (as in the second compound) according to the same rules as those for 付 (Entry ??).		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Homeward	we go after <KILLING> <Kaeru-chan>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
帰る	go back	かえる (kaeru)
日帰り	sun (day) + homeward = day trip	ひ かえり (hi gaeri)
帰国	homeward + country = go back to one's country	キ・コク (KIKOKU)

漢字 14: Section (部)

部	1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10	
Section, department, category.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	立 + 口 + 阝
English	Stand + Mouth + Village/Town/City

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The section of the [opening] where the [village] was [erected].

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A section	on <BULLEYING>.
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** Irregular Reading(s)

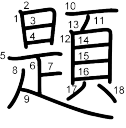
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
部屋	section + roof = room (of a house, etc.)	へや (heya)

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
全部	complete + section = all; the whole	ゼン・ブ (ZEN-BU)
上部	upper + section = upper section / part	ジョウ・ブ (JŌ-BU)
部分	section + part = part; portion	ブ・ブン (BU-BUN)

♪ Pronunciations

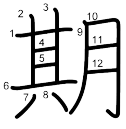
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ブ (BU)	—
L.C.	—	—

漢字 15: Topic (題)	
	
Topic, Theme.	
This is the only instance in the general-use 漢字 in which the character for ‘approve’ is stretched out.	
∈ Composition	
Glyphs	是 + 頁
English	Approve (??) + Big shell
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Topic	of [face-recognition] was [approved].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ダイ (DAI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The topic	of 〈DYING〉 is unsettling.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
問題	question + topic = <i>problem; issue</i>	モン・ダイ (MON·DAI)
宿題	lodging + topic = <i>homework</i>	シュク・ダイ (SHUKU·DAI)
主題	primary + topic = <i>theme; subject</i>	シュ・ダイ (SHU·DAI)

漢字 16: Period (期)	
	
Period (of time).	
∈ Composition	
Glyphs	目 + 八 + 月
English	Eye + Eight + Moon/Month
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Period	around [8]’o clock where the [moon] turns into an Amaterasu [eye].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キ (KI)	—
L.C.	ゴ (GO)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Period	of 〈GOBBLING〉 what you have 〈 KILLED 〉.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
期間	period + interval = <i>period of time</i>	キ・カン (KIKAN)
期待	period + wait = <i>expectation</i>	キ・タイ (KITAI)
定期	fixed + period = <i>fixed period</i>	テイ・キ (TEIKI)

漢字 17: Grant (授)		
		
To grant, impart.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	扌 + 受	
English	Hand + Receive (??)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
To grant	something with your [actions] means there must be a [receiving] party.	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジュ (JU)	—
L.C.	—	さず (sazu)
♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Grants were <JUDICIOUSLY> given at the <same zoo>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
授業	grant + business = <i>lesson; instruction</i>	ジュ・ギョウ (JU-GYŌ)
授与	grant + confer = <i>awarding; conferring</i>	ジュ・ヨ (JU-YO)
教授	teach + grant = <i>teaching; a professor</i>	キョウ・ジュ (KYŌ-JU)

漢字 18: Delivery (便)		
便		
This character has an array of meanings, from postal services, convenience and opportunity to bodily functions such as defecation and urination. Underlying everything, when you think about it though, is a sense of ‘delivering’ things or of things being delivered in some way.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亻 + 更	
English	Man/Person + Anew (??)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Delivery	makes a [person] feel [anew].	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ベン、ピン (BEN, BIN)	—
ベン is the reading used in compounds related to both convenience and bodily functions, as in the first two examples below.		
ピン appears in compounds having to do with mail (such as in the final example) and opportunity.		
L.C.	—	たよ (tayo)
♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Delivered from <BINGE> drinking; I <BENDED> in the direction of <Thai Yoga>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry ?? that the first 2 漢字 in the final compound mean ‘urgen’ when taken together.		
便利	delivery + profit = <i>convenient; handy</i>	ベン・リ (BEN-RI)
便所	delivery + location = <i>toilet; lavatory</i>	ベン・ジョ (BEN-JO)
至急便	urgent + delivery = <i>express (mail)</i>	シ・キウ・ビン (SHI-KYŪ-BIN)

漢字 19: Annual (歳)

Annual, year, age.

When used as a suffix, this 漢字 translates as ‘... years old’.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	戈 + 止 + 一 + 止 + 少
English	Spear/Halberd + Slash + One + Stop + Small

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Annually [slash] the [axe] [horizontally] to [stop] being [small].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	サイ (SAI)	—
L.C.	セイ (SEI)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The annual <SAILING> competition <PSYCHES> everyone up.

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
二十歳	twenty + annual = <i>twenty years old</i>	はたち (hatachi)

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall as well from Entry ?? that 何 (in the first compound) can express the idea of ‘how many’ in addition to ‘what’.		
The famous word in the second example is the only time this reading becomes voiced; recall from Entry ?? that 万 is read with is less common 音読み here.		
何歳	what + annual = <i>how many years old</i>	なん・サイ (nan·SAI)
万歳	ten thousand + annual = <i>Hurrah!</i>	バン・ザイ (BAN·ZAI)
五歳	five + annual = <i>five years old</i>	ゴ・サイ (GO·SAI)

漢字 20: Exclusive (専)

Exclusive.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	十 + 寸 + 田
English	Ten + Inch + Field

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The exclusive [inch] [cross] was found in the [field].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セン (SEN)	—
L.C.	—	もっぱ (moppa)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The exclusive <mopper> available at any CBD <CENTRE>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
専門	exclusive + gate = <i>specialty</i>	セン・モン (SEN·MON)
専用	exclusive + utilize = <i>exclusive use; private use</i>	セン・ヨウ (SEN·YŌ)
専有	exclusive + have = <i>exclusive possession</i>	セン・ユウ (SEN·YŪ)

漢字 21: Orient (向)

To orient, to look on. The overall sense is of things either orienting themselves or being oriented in a literal or figurative direction.

When used as a suffix as in the second compound below, the meaning becomes 'intended for' or 'suited to'. Take care not to confuse this 漢字 with 同 'same' from Entry ??.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	冂 + 口 + 丶
English	To enclose + Mouth + Dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Oriental	[wildernesses] fill your [mouths] with [dust].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	む (mu)
Although む usually acts as a verb stem (as in the first example below), it's worth being aware that the word 向こう (むこう/mukō) is actually a noun meaning 'the other side/party' or <i>beyond</i> .		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Orient	your <CAUSE> to the <moon>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
向かう	face on; be opposite	むかう (mukau)
夏向き	summer + orient = for summer	なつ むき (natsu muki)
向学心	orient + study + heart = love of learning	コウ・ガク・シン (KŌGAKUSHIN)

漢字 22: Train (練)

To train, knead.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	糸 + 東
English	Thread + East (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Training	[eastern] [threading].
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♪ Pronunciations

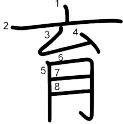
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	レン (REN)	ね (ne)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Training	<necromancy> while <RENTING> a house in the Netherworld.
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+ Words and Compounds

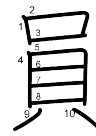
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
練る	to train; knead	ねる (neru)
練習	train + learn = practice; exercise	レン・シュウ (REN.SHŪ)
訓練	instruction + train = training; discipline	クン・レン (KUN.REN)

漢字 23: Raise (育)		
		
To raise, bring up (as in children).		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	厶 + 𠂇 + 月	
English	Self/Private + Lid/Top + Meat	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Raise your own [flesh] and bone to become [himself] the [top] of the family one day.		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イク (IKU)	そだ (soda)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Raise your children by <EKE-ING> out the <soda> usage.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
育てる	raise; bring up	そだてる (sodateru)
教育	teach + raise = education	キョウイク (KYŌIKU)
体育	body + raise = physical education	タイイク (TAIiku)

漢字 24: Consider (考)		
		
Consider, think about.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	耂 + 勹	
English	Old + Wrap/Embrace	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Consider	and	[embrace] the [old] ways.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	かんが (kanga)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Consider the <CAUSE> of the <kangaroos?> assault on us.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
考える	consider; think about	かんがえる (kangaeru)
思考	think + consider = thinking; consideration	シ・コウ (SHIKŌ)
考古学	consider + old + study = archeology	コウ・コ・ガク (KŌ-KO-GAKU)

漢字 25: Member (員)		
		
Member.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	口 + 貝	
English	Mouth + Shell	
♣ ∈ Meaning ⇔ Glyph Components		
Member	of the [vampire]-[shell] club.	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イン (IN)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
A member of the (INKLINGS).		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
全員	complete + member = <i>all members; the whole staff</i>	ゼン・イン (ZEN-IN)
店員	shop + member = <i>clerk; shop assistant</i>	テン・イン (TEN-IN)
社員	company + member = <i>employee; member</i>	シャ・イン (SHAIN)